



Free games for Android

We count down 10 free games that you must play if you own an Android smartphone or tablet <http://bit.ly/Ib7wPL>

Free cloud storage options

Want to shift your important data on the cloud. We take a look at 5 free options available for users in the market <http://bit.ly/HwdtFO>

BLUETOOTH HEADSET



Plantronics Marque M155

Price: ₹3,590

CELLPHONE



HTC Rhyme

Price: ₹25,950

PORTABLE PC



ZOTAC ZBOX Nano ID61 Plus

Price: ₹22,000

TABLET



HCL Me Tablet U1

Price: ₹7,999

SPECIFICATIONS

Type.....Bluetooth headset
Version.....3.0 with A2DP
Weight.....7 grams
Talk time.....5 hours

Specifications.....Android 2.3.5
Processor.....Qualcomm MSM8255
RAM.....768MB
Display.....3.7-inch S-LCD

Processor.....Intel Celeron 867
RAM.....2 GB DDR3
HDD.....320 GB @ 5400RPM
Display ports.....HDMI, DisplayPort

OS.....Android 4.0.3 ICS
Processor.....ARM Cortex A8 1GHz
RAM.....512MB
Display size.....7-inch

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All scores out of 10)

Features.....7.5

It comes with A2DP, but really takes the cake with the ability to respond to voice commands.

Performance.....7.0

Very clear call clarity and sufficiently loud as well. Doesn't suffer in noisy environments. Could do with a bit less treble heavy nature at higher volumes.

Build Quality.....8.5

Classy looks, comfortable to wear for longer durations.

Value for money.....7.5

Definitely worth considering, along with the Jabra Wave Red.

Features.....7.0

Attractive and compact design. Vibrant display with sense 3.5 UI skinned over Android 2.3.5. HTC Charm is a useless accessory.

Performance.....6.5

An overall good performer. No access to the battery is the biggest downer.

Build Quality.....7.0

Overall plastic with a metal strip on the rear giving the device a good build.

Value for money.....6.0

Consumer is spoiled for choice at the ₹25,000 price point.

Features.....7.5

Sports a WiFi module, USB 3.0 ports, HDMI out and houses a Celeron 867 processor which is better than Pinetrail platform.

Performance.....7.0

Performs better than the AMD 450 as well as Intel D2700 processor based ZBOXes.

Build Quality.....7.0

Very sturdy build although the glossy surface is a dust and fingerprint magnet.

Value for money.....7.0

Pricing is very attractive if you have basic computing needs.

Features.....5.0

Sports ICS OS and has a variety of connectivity options. Lacks Google Play and has an HCL store.

Performance.....5.0

A bit sluggish when compared to the competition. Below par performance.

Build Quality.....6.5

Well built with a white glossy plastic finish giving the device an elegant look but making it a fingerprint magnet.

Value for money.....4.0

At ₹7,999 it's the cheapest ICS tablet but definitely not the best.

WE SAY

7.5

The design and colour combination are one of the classiest combos we have seen on a Bluetooth headset in a long time. The clean look for the most part should go down well with most potential buyers. Very light as well, but the Jabra Wave Red takes a slight advantage in terms of in-ear comfort over long durations. Battery life is neck and neck too. The Plantronics Marque M155 is for you if you like the idea of voice commands to control the headset.

7.0

Hard to recommend a single-core smartphone in a day ruled by the dual cores. The camera has some nice effects. Apps run smoothly until you start some heavy multitasking. The Rhyme is expected to receive the ICS update soon, making it future proof. If you are in the market to pick up a device close to the ₹25,000 mark, we suggest that you take a look at the Sony Ericsson XPERIA Arc S, HTC Sensation or the Nokia Lumia 800 before making your buying decision.

7.0

This can be used as a proper computer system if you only plan to use mainly office suite and surf the net. Watching HD movies is a great experience. Just hook it up to your HDTV and get more variety than any smart TV. With the Windows Media Centre remote, it works great as an HTPC. Not meant for gaming though. HDD is quite slow with transfer speeds. You might want to invest in a faster HDD. If you are willing to invest in a better HDD, then get the ID61 version which comes without the 320GB HDD at a mere ₹15,500.

5.0

Overall, the HCL Me Tab U1 is an average performer when compared to the competing ICS budget tablets. The lack of the Google Play store is the biggest downer of this device. The overall performance was below par and the occasional lag really hampers the experience. If you are in the market to pick up a tablet in the sub ₹10,000 price range, we suggest you take a look at the competition first. Not only because they offer access to the Google Play Store straight out of the box, but also because they are overall better performers.